❷ Calls the database

❸ Closes the connections

Now you can run the test. Depending on the elements in your database, the output looks something like this:

```
Some(scontainer-type-key|11)
Some(scontainer-type-key|9)
Some(scontainer-type-key|9)
Some(scontainer-type-key|11)
...
None
None
...
```

Next you learn how to connect to an actor from within an Akka stream. Actors are useful for maintaining state in a concurrent application. There are no race conditions, so you can focus on the business logic.

16.2 Connecting to an actor

You can use an actor for windowing in a stream. This is when you want to process a certain number of elements in groups defined by certain constraints. Usually the constraint is time—elements processed in a certain amount of time—but it can also be domain-oriented, opening and closing the window when specific elements are processed.

An example of these two possible constraints, time and domain, is a user session. You can open the window with the first interaction you receive from a user, indicating the session's beginning. Later, each additional item from that user is added to the window. Finally, when you get an item indicating that the user session is over, you can close